■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Wednesday, October 28, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (6 stories)

■ *A world first basic income trial gave 211 Indigenous people in Peru’s Amazon about £2 a day for two years. Households unable to afford nutritious food fell from 73% to 26%, while 87% took part in rainforest protection, including tree planting and restoring water sources.*

The Angle: *A world first basic income trial gave 211 Indigenous people in Peru’s Amazon about £2 a day for two years. Households unable to afford nutritious food fell from 73% to 26%, while 87% took part in rainforest protection, including tree planting and restoring water sources.*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.bath.ac.uk/announcements/world-first-basic-income-trial-boosts-indigenous-livelihoods-and-amazon-rainforest-protection/

■■ *Grand jury declines to indict Trump critic Cassidy Hutchinson over Jan. 6 testimony*

The Angle: *She became one of the most talked-about witnesses of the Jan. 6 hearings, and there'd been chatter about legal blowback for her testimony - a grand jury just shut that down, so it's a real 'where are we now' moment on one of the biggest political stories of the decade.*

- A **grand jury** declined to **indict Cassidy Hutchinson** over her **Jan. 6 testimony**.
- **Hutchinson** rose to national attention as a key witness against **Trump** during the Jan. 6 committee hearings.
- The decision means no criminal charges tied to her testimony.

The Debate Starter

- Is this a win for the system working as it should, or proof the whole thing was overblown from the jump?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbsnews.com/news/grand-jury-declines-to-indict-trump-critic-cassidy-hutchinson-over-jan-6-testimony/

■ *AI startup hacks Anthropic in 12 hours, gains access to employee details and internal messages*

The Angle: *The company behind Claude is supposed to be obsessed with AI safety and security — so a rival startup cracking their systems in half a day and walking away with employee info and internal chats is the kind of irony that writes itself.*

- Reported breach reportedly took just **12 hours** from start to finish
- The hackers were themselves an **AI startup**, not a lone hacker group
- Access reportedly included **employee details** and **internal messages**
- Target was **Anthropic**, the company behind the Claude AI models

The Irony Alarm

- The company built to keep AI 'safe' just got outsmarted by another AI company in half a day — does that scare you or does it feel inevitable?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.indiatoday.in/technology/news/story/ai-startup-hacks-anthropic-in-12-hours-gains-access-to-employee-details-and-internal-messages-3025452-2026-10-26

■ *Grand Theft Auto 6 Download Size Revealed To Be 210 GB*

The Angle: *GTA 6 is the most anticipated game release in years, and now gamers are realizing they might need to clear out half their console just to install it.*

- Reported download size for **Grand Theft Auto 6** is **210 GB**.
- That's roughly double the size of many modern blockbuster titles.
- Gamers are already joking about needing to delete other games just to make room.

The Debate Starter

- 210 GB for one game — are you deleting stuff to make room, or is it time to admit physical media had a point?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://insider-gaming.com/gta-6-install-size-revealed-210-gb/

■ *"Musk" heads to PVOD early on 11/6 via indie distributor Bleecker Street after its theatrical run collapsed amid Elon's $1B Skydance investment & growing censorship concerns*

The Angle: *A film literally called "Musk" is skipping its theatrical run and dropping early on demand - and the timing lines up with Elon's $1 billion stake in Skydance, which is fueling talk that the richest man alive just helped bury his own movie.*

- The film **"Musk"** is bypassing theaters and launching early on **PVOD (premium video-on-demand) on 11/6**
- It's being handled by scrappy indie distributor **Bleecker Street** after the wider theatrical release reportedly fell apart
- The collapse comes amid **Elon Musk's $1 billion investment in Skydance**
- Reports point to growing **censorship concerns** as part of why this movie's rollout got shaken up

The Debate Starter

- Is this just a straightforward distribution flop - or did Elon's own money just quietly determine how his story gets told?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tvfandomlounge.com/alex-gibney-elon-musk-doc-early-digital-release/

■■ *Jon Stewart Makes Midterm Plea to Vote Against Trump: 'Send a Message to This Reckless S—tshow of an Administration'*

The Angle: *Jon Stewart dropped a no-filter, profanity-laced call to the polls ahead of the midterms, and it's blowing up online — the kind of celebrity-meets-politics moment that always gets people arguing about whether stars should be telling us how to vote.*

- **Jon Stewart** is urging voters to turn out for the **midterms** specifically to vote against **Trump**
- He wants people to "**send a message**" to what he bluntly called a "**reckless s—tshow of an administration**"
- The plea is already circulating widely on **Reddit** and social media

The Debate Starter

- Should celebrities like Stewart be using their platform to tell fans how to vote — or does that just turn people off?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thewrap.com/media-platforms/journalism/jon-stewart-plea-to-voters-against-trump-midterms/

Backup options:

■■ *Jon Stewart on the midterms: 'Republicans running for Congress can't defend Trump's reckless record'*

The Angle: *One of the sharpest voices in political comedy is going straight at Republicans just ahead of the midterms, and that kind of celebrity jab at a sitting party always gets people talking and arguing.*

- **Jon Stewart** says **Republicans** running for Congress "can't defend **Trump's** reckless record"

- The comment comes as the **midterms** draw closer and candidates start getting pressed on the president

The Debate Starter

- Is Stewart calling it straight, or is this just a comedian taking a free shot at an easy target?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/culture/2026/oct/27/jon-stewart-midterms-republicans-congress-trump?CMP=oth_b-aplnews_d-1

🛩■ *Flavio Bolsonaro has fled Brazil to the U.S. after election defeat*

The Angle: *This isn't just a political footnote - it's the son of a former president allegedly skipping the country with his whole family right as police moved to lock down his travel docs over a money laundering probe. That kind of real-time fugitive drama is exactly the stuff that gets people glued to the news.*

- A Reuters source says **Flavio Bolsonaro** left Brazil with his **wife and two daughters**
- The exit came just **hours after** Brazilian police cancelled his passports
- Police say he **failed to comply** with a **24-hour order** to surrender those passports
- It's all tied to a **money laundering probe**, which Bolsonaro **denies**

The Debate Starter

- Is fleeing right before your passport gets pulled a sign of guilt, or just a politically connected family protecting itself?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/k1fmz9mgs1yh1.png

■■ *Netanyahu, Eisenkot stake rival claims to lead Israel after deadlocked vote*

The Angle: *Israel just had an election with no winner, and now the sitting Prime Minister and his biggest rival are both standing up saying 'I run this.' That kind of political gridlock in a major U.S. ally always has ripple effects worth talking about.*

- **Benjamin Netanyahu** is calling for a right-wing coalition government after Tuesday's vote.
- Rival **Gadi Eisenkot** says the results prove voters rejected Netanyahu's long run in power.
- Early vote counting showed **no clear winner** — a flat-out deadlock.
- Both men are publicly staking competing claims to lead the country right now.

The Debate Starter

- When an election ends in a tie, who actually gets to say they won?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/israel-vote-deadlock-9.7399140?cmp=rss

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■■ *Why the Hispanic vote could sway the outcome of the U.S. midterm elections*

The Angle: *With roughly 39 million Hispanic voters up for grabs and nobody locked into one party, this bloc could decide who wins the midterms — and it blows up the usual 'red state, blue state' script.*

- **~39 million** Hispanic Americans are eligible to vote this cycle
- Unlike most of the electorate, Hispanic voters have gotten **less** locked into one party during the **Trump era**, not more
- Both **Democrats and Republicans** are actively courting this group because it swings, rather than sticking
- The analysis comes via **CBC** as a key storyline heading into the **U.S. midterms**

The Debate Starter

- Does it surprise you that one of the biggest swing blocs in America right now isn't a swing state — it's a swing demographic?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/us-midterm-elections-latino-hispanic-voters-trump-9.7398181?cmp=rss

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■ *Hundreds of cruise passengers — including cancer patient — left homeless, stranded in Cambodia after ship ran out of fuel*

The Angle: *Hundreds of cruise passengers — including cancer patient — left homeless, stranded in Cambodia after ship ran out of fuel*

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/28/world-news/hundreds-of-cruise-passengers-left-stranded-in-cambodia/

CANADIAN NEWS (4 stories)

■ *Canada could restrict Roblox & Minecraft for under 16s as part of social media ban*

The Angle: *This isn't some obscure app ban — Roblox and Minecraft are basically default childhood right now, so if Canada folds them into a social media crackdown for under-16s, it's a direct hit on millions of households.*

- Reports out of **Canada** suggest **Roblox** and **Minecraft** could get swept into a broader **social media ban for under-16s**
- The move would treat gaming platforms with chat/social features the same as apps like **Instagram** or **TikTok**
- No final policy details yet — this is still being floated, not law

The Debate Starter

- Would you actually support cutting your kid off from Roblox and Minecraft, or is this government overreach into harmless gaming?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.dexerto.com/roblox/canada-could-restrict-roblox-minecraft-for-under-16s-as-part-of-social-media-ban-3422196/

■ *Stelco owner says he could sell plant next year after becoming 'persona non grata in Canada' | CBC News*

The Angle: *A major Canadian steel plant's own owner is publicly trashing the country and floating a sale within a year — that's the kind of foreign-ownership, jobs-on-the-line story that hits home in Hamilton and feeds right into the bigger US-Canada trade/tariff fight.*

- The **owner of Stelco** says he could **sell the plant as early as next year**.
- He claims he's now considered **'persona non grata in Canada.'**
- Stelco is one of **Hamilton, Ontario's** biggest and most historic steel employers.

The Debate Starter

- If the guy running a plant full of Canadian jobs says he's hated here — who do you blame, him or us?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/cleveland-cliffs-ceo-says-willing-to-sell-stelco-9.7398895

■■ *Alberta bill would stop provincial entities from considering diversity, equity and inclusion in hiring*

The Angle: *This drops Alberta right into the middle of the DEI culture war that's been raging across U.S. statehouses and corporate boardrooms - now it's a Canadian legislature debating whether diversity should ever factor into who gets hired for public jobs.*

- **Alberta** is introducing a bill aimed at **provincial entities** - public bodies tied to the government
- The goal: stop those entities from weighing **diversity, equity and inclusion (DEI)** factors in hiring decisions
- It echoes a broader **anti-DEI legislative push** that's already played out in several U.S. states

The Debate Starter

- Should hiring ever consider diversity, or should it be qualifications only, full stop?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/edmonton/alberta-government-bill-stops-dei-hiring-9.7398443

■ *Record amounts of Canadian cannabis seized as smuggling to Europe soars*

The Angle: *Legal weed at home was supposed to kill the black market — instead Canadian bud is now the top cannabis smuggled into Europe, and Belgian customs just had their biggest bust ever. It's the classic legalization loophole nobody talks about.*

- **Belgian customs** seized **21 tonnes** of Canadian cannabis in **2025** alone
- That's more illegal cannabis exports than **any other country in the world** sent to Belgium
- Canada legalized weed back in **2018** — this is one of the messier side effects nobody predicted

The Debate Starter

- Did legalizing weed here just turn Canada into Europe's black-market cannabis supplier?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/investigates/canadian-cannabis-europe-smuggling-record-amounts-seized-9.7397960?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Queen of Canada documentary director wants you to know her followers are still out there*

The Angle: *A new documentary is pulling back the curtain on Romana Didulo, the woman who declared herself 'Queen of Canada,' and the filmmakers say her true believers never actually went away, they just went quiet. That's the kind of 'wait, people still believe this?' story that gets phones ringing.*

- Director **Cristian Gomes** teamed up with journalist **Mack Lamoureux** to make the new doc **Queen of Canada**.
- The film zeroes in on the diehard followers of self-declared monarch **Romana Didulo**, not just her own story.
- Gomes' whole point to CBC: the movement didn't die, the followers just dropped off the radar.

The Debate Starter

- Ever had a friend or relative get pulled into something like this, and did you ever get them back?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/queen-of-canada-director-interview-9.7398939?cmp=rss

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■■ *Why historic wins for women in Ontario's municipal elections are just 'half the battle'*

The Angle: *Monday's municipal votes flipped several Ontario towns to female leadership for the first time ever, including one village that now has an all-female council — a real milestone, but one local leaders say is only step one.*

- Several Ontario cities elected their **first-ever female mayor** on Monday
- A village southwest of **Ottawa** now has an **all-female council**
- Multiple other municipalities also swore in **new female mayors**
- Local leaders quoted say winning the seat is just **"half the battle"**

The Debate Starter

- Why do you think it took this long for some towns to elect their first female mayor?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/ontario-municipal-elections-women-9.7397699?cmp=rss

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■ *'That doesn't work': Joly says 'we need to send a message' about broken Stelco agreement*

The Angle: *A federal minister publicly calling out a major Canadian steelmaker for reneging on a deal is a rare, blunt moment - it's a story about trust, jobs, and whether government promises to industry actually mean anything.*

- Industry Minister **Mélanie Joly** says the agreement with **Stelco** has been broken: **'that doesn't work.'**
- Joly says **'we need to send a message'** - signaling Ottawa may respond, not just complain.
- Centers on **Stelco**, one of Canada's biggest steel producers, and its deal with the federal government.

The Debate Starter

- When a company breaks its word to the government, should there be real consequences - or is this just politicians talking tough?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMi0AFBVV95cUxOQUlpUzZxNFBlaWtsNlM0X1dqN1Y5dmxaallwN0hRS2cxRmhQZC1tSnE3Vk5kc21kY2Q1b3k5OEY3aUNfOVhxXzdROU9WMFVHemNubC1FbW5rVG9nZGo2OUllX1A0b2tvcTg5bUJzNmowUlZBX2lxOFJ0Mnp4dGs3MnphSVNsa2lKVDlPbE95eGx2aTNXZ3hXX0lpYnZqSnh2Tmt5OFotbWJUWUwybk1KRXhJNzFUZUtkOEVYMzFwWmVEWFBxUUJzUVdKUG1hN2I2?oc=5

■■ *Rainy start to the day in Barrie, but will it remain?*

The Angle: *A classic Canadian morning gripe - everyone in Barrie woke up to rain and wants to know if they need the umbrella all day or just for the commute.*

The Local Check-In

- Barrie listeners, text us: are you getting a rain-soaked day or a clearing-up afternoon?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMilAFBVV95cUxPM0xBMGRYejNZa0lNaHI5ME9OT0N1MVUtbU1iZjMzM2lWSHBnM1dKTXBLRko5T0pXMExjeWR6WjR4MEdtV3FnWlM4cjVrRERldzNBQ3NRSTMydk9WYWV1My1HVjM0RUtKTUxTZzNwVF9senBsUnZtbDFoZ1J4XzZ3NzZxbnRkNEwwdjh4TjJldDVMWnZZ?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (5 stories)

■ *Richard Hammond announces move to small Welsh village after split from wife*

The Angle: *The Grand Tour star is making a big personal pivot after splitting from his wife — trading the spotlight for small-town life, and that kind of reinvention story always gets people talking.*

- **Richard Hammond**, best known from **Top Gear** and **The Grand Tour**, is reportedly relocating to a small village in **Wales**.
- The move comes after his split from wife **Mindy Hammond**, closing out a long-standing marriage.
- Details on the new place and what's next for him are still light — but a car-guy icon going quiet-village-life is already a story in itself.

The Debate Starter

- Would you ever ditch the fame and the city for a quiet village after a big life change — or is that just a nice idea nobody actually does?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.independent.co.uk/arts-entertainment/tv/news/richard-hammond-wales-new-home-divorce-b3074148.html

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■■ *Hasan Piker sues CNN Conservative commentator Scott Jennings for defamation*

The Angle: *A left-wing streaming star suing a CNN conservative pundit for defamation is basically the media-war feud hosts live for - it's personal, it's political, and everybody's got a side.*

The Debate Starter

- Does a lawsuit like this actually prove a point, or just hand both guys a bigger platform?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://thehill.com/regulation/court-battles/6176566-piker-defamation-lawsuit-jennings/

■■ *Josh Gad: "If I can fly 15 hours to vote, you can take five minutes to vote. No excuses. Go. Vote."*

The Angle: *Josh Gad is calling out anyone who skips voting over "inconvenience," and it's the kind of celebrity tough-love that gets people either nodding or rolling their eyes — perfect fodder for a quick take.*

- **Josh Gad** — the voice of **Olaf** in **Frozen** — posted a blunt message pushing people to vote.
- His quote: **"If I can fly 15 hours to vote, you can take five minutes to vote. No excuses. Go. Vote."**
- The post is circulating on **Reddit's r/fauxmoi**, a celebrity gossip community known for picking up star social media moments.

The Debate Starter

- Does a celebrity guilt-tripping you into voting actually work, or does it just feel like a lecture?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/9v9mbiuu12yh1.jpeg

■ *Julia Stiles dubs 'DWTS' partner Ezra Sosa a 'cranky bitch' after heated rehearsal*

The Angle: *Dancing With the Stars drama is pure radio gold - a Hollywood actress dropping an unfiltered insult on her dance partner mid-season is exactly the kind of celebrity friction that gets listeners picking sides.*

- **Julia Stiles** called her pro partner **Ezra Sosa** a **'cranky bitch'** after a heated rehearsal
- The blowup came ahead of their **'Horror Movie Night'** performance on Tuesday
- **Sosa** admitted in a confessional he was **'being too hard'** on Stiles during practice

The Debate Starter

- Tough-love coaching or straight-up disrespect - whose side are you on, Julia's or Ezra's?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/28/entertainment/julia-stiles-dubs-dwts-partner-ezra-sosa-a-cranky-bitch-after-heated-rehearsal/

■ *LA approves desperate $1 deal to save Hollywood jobs as production dwindles*

The Angle: *Film and TV shoots keep fleeing Los Angeles for cheaper cities, and now LA is so desperate to keep the industry's crews working that it's practically giving away filming permits - a stark sign of how bad the production slump has gotten.*

- **Los Angeles** just approved new motions allowing productions to film for as little as **$1**
- The move comes days after a fresh report confirmed film and TV production in LA is **still declining**
- Goal is to stop Hollywood jobs and shoots from continuing to leave the city

The Debate Starter

- Is a $1 permit a smart lifeline for Hollywood crews, or proof the industry's in way deeper trouble than we thought?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/28/us-news/la-moves-to-revive-filming-slump-with-1-city-property-deals/

Backup options:

■ *'Back to the Future' star Christopher Lloyd reveals decades-long struggle with addiction - Page Six*

The Angle: *Christopher Lloyd is one of the most beloved faces in movie history, so hearing the 88-year-old 'Back to the Future' icon openly detail a hidden addiction battle in his new memoir is a genuine gut-punch — and a great example of a legend getting brutally honest.*

- **Christopher Lloyd**, now **88**, says he battled addiction to **cocaine and alcohol** for years.
- On trying coke for the first time, he writes: **"I was hooked almost immediately. I loved it."**
- The confession comes from his new memoir, **"In My Own Time: A Memoir."**

The Takeaway

- Doc Brown just reminded us that even the most wholesome childhood icons were fighting battles we never saw.

Page Six (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/27/celebrity-news/back-to-the-future-star-christopher-lloyd-reveals-decades-long-struggle-with-addiction/

■ *'Dexter' turns 20: Michael C. Hall looks back on the shocking twists, infamous endings, and the killer 'Resurrection'*

The Angle: *One of TV's most polarizing anti-heroes is getting the 20th-anniversary victory lap, and it's a built-in nostalgia trip plus a chance to relitigate one of the most hated finales ever.*

- **Dexter** first premiered back in **2004**, turning a blood-spatter analyst with a serial-killer side hustle into a TV icon.
- Star **Michael C. Hall** is doing the full look-back — the twists, the infamous endings, all of it — for the **20th anniversary**.
- The franchise refuses to die: it's now on its latest revival, **'Dexter: Resurrection.'**
- The original series finale is still regularly ranked among the most booed endings in TV history.

The Debate Starter

- What's the TV finale you still haven't forgiven, 20 years later?

Entertainment Weekly (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 77/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMinwFBVV95cUxPS2tzRWNTQmZOSFRocGsyd1RLa0JxaXJKbERlME5MVVBQN24yR0pOOWhfUDNwT1M4U1ZYNDkyYndJbXM2X1BJSnQ0bFZvakcxOTBPcWZMOEh6VXplN3hxZzRjVlBLbTZ6cWoweDluNGo2NkVqYnVSS3hPZjg4eVZfZmo2cDVTdi1sLVRnYVoxUEdNOUlyZV9vWWNZcGxIdjA?oc=5

■ *KATSEYE, MAZZEL Producer Taka Perry Talks Career From Sydney to Tokyo & Appeal of Japanese Music: Unbound Japan Interview*

The Angle: *KATSEYE's one of the biggest crossover pop acts going right now, so hearing from the producer who helped build their sound - and why Japanese music is having a moment globally - is a solid hook for K-pop/J-pop fans tuning in.*

- **Taka Perry** - producer for **KATSEYE** and **MAZZEL** - sat down for an **Unbound Japan** interview
- He traces his own path **from Sydney to Tokyo** building a career in the music industry
- The chat digs into why **Japanese music** is resonating with wider audiences right now

The Fan Pull

- KATSEYE fans - would you have guessed their sound had a Sydney-to-Tokyo pipeline behind it?

X/Twitter @Billboard (Tier 1) | Score: 76/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 19 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/billboard/status/2115337814267052291

■ *The four most revealing insights from Netflix's new Matthew Perry doc*

The Angle: *A new Netflix documentary promises the real story behind Matthew Perry through the people who knew him best — but the loudest headline might be who's missing from it.*

- Director **Robertson** got a handful of **Perry's closest friends** to sit down for the doc
- Perry's sister, **Mia Perry Bowick**, also opened up for the film
- The cast of **'Friends'** reportedly chose not to take part

The Debate Starter

- Why do you think the 'Friends' cast sat this one out?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/entertainment/television/the-four-most-revealing-insights-from-netflixs-new-matthew-perry-doc

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■ *Will These 'Crystal Lake' Ratings Be Enough for a Season 2?*

The Angle: *The Friday the 13th prequel just landed as one of the streamer's top-performing original series, so the horror reboot debate is heating up: does a strong debut actually guarantee Jason comes back for round two?*

- **Crystal Lake** is a prequel series tied to the **Friday the 13th** franchise.
- The show ranked as the **'fourth-best scripted original series'** on its streamer.
- No renewal has been confirmed yet — Season 2 is still an open question.

The Debate Starter

- Does a top-5 streaming debut actually seal a renewal, or do horror reboots always get the short end of the stick?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/will-these-crystal-lake-ratings-be-enough-for-a-season-2-2000831439

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Lowest price ever: You won't believe how affordable COSRX's viral snail mucin with 100K purchases is*

The Angle: *COSRX's cult snail mucin essence has racked up over 100,000 purchases online, and right now it's reportedly as cheap as it's ever been - which is prime territory for a "wait, snails?" conversation and a deal-alert segment.*

- The product is **COSRX's Advanced Snail 96 Mucin Power Essence** - a certified skincare cult favorite.
- It's racked up more than **100,000 purchases**, per the report.
- The deal marks the product's **lowest price ever**, according to the source.

The Debate Starter

- Snail slime on your face - genius skincare hack or the weirdest thing you'd never try?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/28/shopping/cosrx-snail-mucin-is-just-15-on-amazon-right-now/

Backup options:

■ *Noah Wyle Named People's 2026 Sexiest Man Alive - Variety*

The Angle: *People's Sexiest Man Alive pick is an instant pop-culture debate every single year, and this one's got a nostalgia twist — the guy's been in scrubs since '94.*

- **Noah Wyle** has officially been crowned **People's Sexiest Man Alive for 2026** — his first time taking the title.
- People's own framing: he's been "**heating up emergency rooms since 1994**," nodding to his breakout run on **ER**.
- He's back in medical drama mode starring in **"The Pitt."**
- Wyle sat down with **People** for the full interview on landing the honor.

The Debate Starter

- Good pick or total snub — who do YOU think should've won Sexiest Man Alive this year?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/noah-wyle-people-2026-sexiest-man-alive-1236931645/

■ *Carrie Ann Inaba, Val Chmerkovskiy caught having emotional conversation in 'DWTS' ballroom after suspension drama*

The Angle: *Val Chmerkovskiy's first night back from a one-week suspension over his social media conduct, and cameras caught him locked in a heart-to-heart with judge Carrie Ann Inaba right at the judges' table — prime speculation fuel for fans.*

- **Val Chmerkovskiy** just returned from a **one-week suspension** tied to inappropriate social media behavior.
- He was caught having an **intense, emotional conversation** with judge **Carrie Ann Inaba**.
- The moment happened right at the **judges' table** in the **'DWTS' ballroom**, in full view of cameras.

The Debate Starter

- What do you think Carrie Ann said to Val — a stern warning, or a genuine olive branch?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/28/entertainment/inside-val-chmerkovskiy-carrie-ann-inabas-cathartic-conversation-in-dwts-ballroom/

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *How this year’s best optical illusions trick your brain - The Washington Post*

The Angle: *Every year there's a fresh batch of mind-bending optical illusions that go viral because people can't believe their own eyes — it's the ultimate 'try this at home right now' segment.*

- The winning entry features **two identical gears**, each with **eight teeth**, spinning at the same speed with their teeth touching.
- When you stare directly at one gear, the other one — seen only through **peripheral vision** — appears to warp or move differently than it actually does.
- The illusion works purely because of how peripheral vision processes motion differently than direct focus.

The Try-It-Live Bit

- Pull up the gear illusion on air and have each host describe what they see — bet you it's not the same thing.

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Pull up the image** - Before the segment starts -> Producer loads the spinning gears illusion on a screen or shares the link in the group chat/socials.
- **Step 2: Stare test, live** - 30 seconds on air -> Each host stares at one gear while describing out loud what the other gear looks like it's doing in their peripheral vision.
- **Step 3: Compare notes** - Right after -> Hosts compare what they each perceived — since it varies person to person, this is where the fun debate happens.
- **Step 4: Open the phones/socials** - Wrap-up -> Ask listeners to try it themselves and call in or comment on what they saw.

The Washington Post (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.washingtonpost.com/health/2026/10/27/how-this-years-best-optical-illusions-trick-your-brain/

Backup options:

■ *Young adults with cancer report getting dismissed by doctors*

The Angle: *This hits home because it's not about some rare medical mystery - it's about young, healthy-seeming people going to the doctor with real symptoms and being told it's 'just stress' or 'too young to worry about,' sometimes for months before a diagnosis. Everyone listening either knows someone this happened to or has a story about being dismissed by a doctor themselves.*

The Relatable Gut-Punch

- Have you ever had a doctor dismiss something that turned out to be serious? Call in.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.futurity.org/young-adults-cancer-3350622-2/?utm_campaign=young-adults-cancer-3350622-2

■ *Dogs’ Mouths Harbor Parasites Associated With Humans, Revealing a Potentially Overlooked Source of Cross-Species Parasite Exposure. Research can't establish whether our pets are getting these oral parasites directly from us, but that is a possibility.*

The Angle: *New research found parasites normally associated with humans living in dogs' mouths — and scientists can't rule out that we're the ones giving it to them, not the other way around. It's a gross, relatable 'wait, what' story anyone who lets their dog lick their face will want to hear.*

- **Researchers** found parasites typically linked to **humans** showing up in **dogs' mouths**
- Scientists say it's a **potentially overlooked source** of cross-species parasite exposure
- The study **can't confirm** whether pets are catching these parasites directly from their owners — but says it's **a real possibility**

The Gross-Out Confession

- Be honest — does your dog lick your face, and are you rethinking that after hearing this?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/your-dogs-mouth-may-be-crawling-with-human-associated-parasites

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CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *Ohio pastor reveals he's had 2 wives for 3 years: Having only 1 wife is 'unbiblical'*

The Angle: *A sitting pastor just admitted he's been secretly running two marriages for three years and is defending it from the pulpit as biblical — that's the kind of hypocrisy-meets-theology combo that writes itself for two hosts.*

- An **Ohio pastor** has publicly revealed he's had **2 wives simultaneously for 3 years**
- He claims having only **one wife is "unbiblical"**
- Story surfaced via **r/nottheonion**, the internet's go-to feed for too-weird-for-fiction real news

The Debate Starter

- Is this guy a bold truth-teller or just a pastor who got caught and found a Bible verse to cover it?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.christianpost.com/news/ohio-pastor-reveals-hes-had-2-wives-for-3-years.html

Backup options:

■ *It started with a joke about gold decor—now two presidents are fighting over the cheesecake factory*

The Angle: *This is peak 'you can't make this up' news - a petty joke about gold decor somehow snowballed into an actual diplomatic spat over, of all things, the Cheesecake Factory. Perfect oddball kicker to send the show out on.*

- It reportedly started as **a joke about gold decor**
- Escalated into **two actual presidents** trading shots
- The flashpoint? **The Cheesecake Factory** - yes, the chain restaurant

The Head-Scratcher

- Of all the hills for world leaders to die on, who guessed it'd be the free bread at the Cheesecake Factory?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.chron.com/news/article/cheesecake-factory-trump-obama-22497504.php

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FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/5 this month; TECH TALK 4/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *AI safety expert stops saving for retirement because he believes AI could wipe out humanity within a decade*

The Angle: *An actual AI safety researcher is so convinced doomsday tech is coming that he's ditched his 401(k) — the kind of real-world doomsday math that splits a room instantly between 'he's crazy' and 'he might be onto something.'*

- The man identifies as an **AI safety expert** — someone who studies this stuff for a living, not a random doomsayer.
- He's **stopped saving for retirement** entirely because of it.
- His reasoning: he believes **AI could wipe out humanity within the next decade**.

The Debate Starter

- If you genuinely believed the world had 10 years left, would you stop saving — or does that just sound like a bad excuse to stop budgeting?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/114353-ai-safety-expert-stops-saving-retirement-because-believes.html

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■ *AI models describe humans as a bunch of amoral sheep*

The Angle: *An AI model allegedly summed up humanity as amoral sheep, and that's exactly the kind of brutal, out-of-nowhere one-liner that blows up online because it's funny, a little insulting, and weirdly hard to argue with.*

The Reality Check

- The robots are roasting us now - call in and defend the human race.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theregister.com/ai-and-ml/2026/10/23/ai-models-describe-humans-as-a-bunch-of-amoral-sheep/5305123

■ *Trump Wants to Ban Use of the Term 'Artificial Intelligence' and 'AI'*

The Angle: *A sitting-president-level push to literally outlaw the term 'AI' would ripple through every tech company, headline, and ad campaign in North America — it's the kind of head-scratcher that gets instant reaction from anyone who's used ChatGPT or Siri this week.*

- **Trump** is reportedly pushing to ban official use of the terms **'artificial intelligence'** and **'AI.'**
- Story is making the rounds today out of **Reddit's r/technology**, with no bill text or official statement attached yet.
- No word yet on what the replacement term would even be.

The Head-Scratcher

- If 'AI' gets banned, what should we call it instead — and does a rule like this even hold up?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/digital/news/trump-artificial-intelligence-officially-ban-term-ai-1236932249/

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *Anthropic files for potentially the biggest IPO ever as CEO warns of risk to humanity from AI*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Anthropic is synonymous with the AI boom right now, and 'biggest IPO ever' paired with the CEO's own humanity-risk warning is an irresistible contradiction that cuts across business, tech, and doom-narrative audiences simultaneously.
The Angle: *The guy running one of the biggest AI companies on earth is telling everyone his own tech could be dangerous to humanity — right as he's asking Wall Street to hand him a record-breaking pile of cash for it. That's the kind of contradiction that writes itself.*

- **Anthropic** has reportedly filed paperwork for an IPO that could be the **biggest ever**
- At the same time, Anthropic's **CEO** is publicly warning that AI poses a **risk to humanity**
- Same company, same leader: sell the warning and sell the stock at the same time

The Irony Alert

- If the guy building the robot thinks it might end us, would you still buy the stock?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://apnews.com/article/anthropic-ipo-shares-public-ca2f4c282bef3201a392e59e3df2300c

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■ *Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella says he has changed his mind about the idea that alignment would naturally emerge as AI systems became more capable.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Nadella publicly reversing his stance on AI alignment is a 'even the optimists are scared now' story that lands perfectly alongside the Anthropic IPO news cycle and will get picked up by every AI-safety and tech outlet chasing that narrative.
The Angle: *Satya Nadella is one of the most powerful people in tech, and he just publicly reversed course on whether AI will naturally learn to behave as it gets smarter — that's a big deal when he's the one steering Microsoft's AI bets.*

- **Satya Nadella**, Microsoft's CEO, says he's changed his mind on AI "alignment."
- He used to believe alignment — AI systems actually doing what humans want — would just happen on its own as the tech got more capable.
- Now he's saying that assumption doesn't hold up.

The Debate Starter

- If the guy running Microsoft isn't confident AI will police itself, why should the rest of us be?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.businessinsider.com/satya-nadella-ai-alignment-changed-mind-different-problem-scales-2026-10

■ *Lamar Odom becomes first NBA player to join Only Fans: "I've always been an open book"*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A first-of-its-kind celebrity milestone (first NBA player on OnlyFans) with a quotable line is tailor-made for quick aggregation and social reaction content regardless of subreddit upvotes.
The Angle: *Lamar Odom becomes first NBA player to join Only Fans: "I've always been an open book"*

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.basketballnetwork.net/off-the-court/lamar-odom-becomes-first-nba-player-to-join-only-fans

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■ *What happened when 46 battle-scarred US veterans went on a week-long ayahuasca retreat: 'Can't put a price on that' https://t.co/aXBBEaBEOA*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Combat veterans + ayahuasca + a quotable 'can't put a price on that' line is a high-emotion, trend-aligned (psychedelic therapy) human-interest piece that radio audiences specifically respond to, even though X engagement metrics undercount it.
The Angle: *Psychedelic therapy for PTSD keeps creeping from fringe to mainstream, and nearly four dozen combat veterans just tried it together for a week — this is the kind of "is it legit or is it woo-woo" story that splits a room fast.*

- **46** US combat veterans took part in a **week-long ayahuasca retreat**
- One veteran's takeaway: **"Can't put a price on that"**
- The trip is being framed as a shot at healing deep combat trauma, not a vacation

The Debate Starter

- Would you send a struggling vet to a jungle retreat over traditional therapy — or does that feel like a Hail Mary?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2115399070487376333

■ *Flávio Bolsonaro flees Brazil through Argentina, en route to Ecuador, migration authority says https://t.co/ibA9umLHxy*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A Bolsonaro family member fleeing the country through two borders is exactly the kind of fast-moving political-intrigue story that gets picked up broadly once wire services catch up, regardless of early Twitter likes.

The Angle: *The son of a former president skipping across borders to dodge Brazilian authorities is the kind of real-life political thriller that crosses borders in interest too, not just geography.*

- **Flávio Bolsonaro**, son of former Brazilian president **Jair Bolsonaro**, has reportedly fled Brazil
- Migration officials say he crossed through **Argentina**
- He's believed to be heading to **Ecuador**
- The move comes amid his father's ongoing legal troubles back home

The Debate Starter

- When a politician's family starts fleeing the country, is that the clearest sign yet that the walls are closing in?

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2115390738640883853

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 6 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Claude Allegedly Let a Digital Grandma Die Rather Than Recite Justin Bieber Lyrics in a Bizarre AI Test" (Reddit r/nottheonion, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Dan Quinn ‘definitely knew it was 4th down’ after lip readers questioned Commanders bizarre play" (nypost.com, banked 2026-10-20)
- "HUNTER: Hug-a-thug judges hit daily double of bizarre decisions" (torontosun.com, banked 2026-10-20)
- "Heidi Klum frightens fans, teases Halloween costume with bizarre close-up of strange prosthetic" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-10-25)
- "Well no duh..." (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-10-27)
- "Aljamain Sterling finds Aaron Pico's claim about protecting ranking 'bizarre' - MMA Junkie" (USA Today (via Google News), banked 2026-10-27)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 19 banked (+15 each when found)
- "30 of the Most Fool-Proof (and Romantic) Anniversary Gifts for Him" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-10-12)
- "The Atari 800XL is back as a $220 retro machine with a real keyboard, HDMI, and a working cartridge slot" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-12)
- "‘Three Days Of Rain’ Broadway Revival With François Arnaud, David Corenswet & Yvonne Strahovski Sets Opening Date, Venue" (deadline.com, banked 2026-10-13)
- "Why the ‘Girls’ Revival Is Such an Exciting Idea" (variety.com, banked 2026-10-13)
- "Why the 'Girls' Revival Is Such an Exciting Idea https://t.co/lTSfPsejyB" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-10-13)
- "London society frets as King Charles skips major high-culture event" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Olivia Rodrigo and Chappell Roan Compete on Game Shows Hosted by David Byrne in the Retro Video for 'Expectations' Remix https://t.co/sBX7jh" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Olivia Rodrigo Taps Chappell Roan (and David Byrne) for Retro ‘Expectations’ Remix" (www.rollingstone.com, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Seahawks vs. Broncos, ‘Thursday Night Football’ game chat and live discussion - Field Gulls" (Field Gulls (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-10-16)
- "Iron Maiden Announce Surprise 2027 North American Tour" (www.rollingstone.com, banked 2026-10-18)
- "‘Other Desert Cities’ Theater Review: Julia Louis-Dreyfus, Ed Harris and Allison Janney Fail to Make a Once-Timely Play Relevant Again" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Rita Wilson Says She’s Returning for Lena Dunham’s ‘Girls’ Revival: ‘I Would Do Anything for Her’" (variety.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Rita Wilson Teases Return In Lena Dunham’s ‘Girls’ Revival On HBO: “I Would Do Anything For Her”" (deadline.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-20)
- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-20)
- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-21)
- "The Best Tools to Redo the Windows Taskbar" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-26)

- "Hilary Duff takes bedazzled eyebrows for a spin in dreamy Paper magazine cover shoot" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-10-26)
- "New Scrooge takes over in ‘Muppet Christmas Carol’ revival" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-10-26)

Newly banked this run:
- WHAT THE FRIDAY: "Well no duh..."

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 1 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-10-28 09:42 AM